SEVERITY & CASE CLASSIFICATION

Pharmacovigilance Internship Task

Submitted by: Atharva Dhage **Course:** Pharm D

Objective: Differentiate Serious vs Non-Serious adverse drug reaction cases and document the applicable regulatory classification.

1. Key Concepts

Term	Definition
Seriousness	Regulatory classification based on outcomes such as death, life-threatening event, hospitalization/prolongation, persistent/significant disability, congenital anomaly, or another medically important event.
Severity	Intensity or degree of an adverse event, such as mild, moderate, or severe. Severity and seriousness are not synonymous.
Serious case	A case meeting at least one recognized seriousness criterion.
Non-serious case	A case that does not meet a seriousness criterion based on the available information.

2. Case Assessment Matrix

Case	Clinical scenario	Seriousness criterion	Classification
1	Mild generalized rash and itching after an antibiotic; outpatient management; no hospitalization or disability.	None identified	Non-Serious
2	Severe nausea and vomiting after chemotherapy requiring admission for IV fluids and medical management.	Hospitalization	Serious
3	Transient dizziness and headache resolving with observation; no admission or significant intervention.	None identified	Non-Serious
4	Acute drug-related respiratory compromise requiring emergency treatment and hospitalization.	Life-threatening / Hospitalization	Serious
5	Persistent drug-related neurological impairment causing significant functional disability.	Persistent/significant disability	Serious

3. Case-wise Rationale

Case 1 – Non-Serious: The reaction is limited to rash and itching. No death, life-threatening consequence, hospitalization, persistent disability, congenital anomaly, or other stated seriousness criterion is present.

Case 2 – Serious: Hospitalization for management of severe vomiting and dehydration/need for IV fluids meets a seriousness criterion. 'Severe' describes intensity; hospitalization determines seriousness.

Case 3 – Non-Serious: Transient dizziness and headache resolved with observation and did not result in hospitalization, disability, death, or another stated seriousness criterion.

Case 4 – Serious: Respiratory compromise requiring emergency treatment represents a potentially life-threatening event and hospitalization. Either criterion is sufficient for serious classification.

Case 5 – Serious: Persistent neurological impairment with significant functional limitation meets the seriousness criterion of persistent/significant disability.

4. Reporting Timeline – Educational Regulatory Framework

Situation	General principle
Serious, unexpected case	Expedited safety reporting timelines apply according to the applicable regulatory framework and reporting rules.
Fatal or life-threatening unexpected serious reaction in a clinical trial	ICH E2A describes a 7-day initial reporting expectation, with follow-up information as required.
Other reportable serious unexpected cases	ICH E2A describes a 15-day reporting expectation for expedited reports.

5. Final Classification Summary

Case	Classification	Reason
1	Non-Serious	No seriousness criterion identified
2	Serious	Hospitalization
3	Non-Serious	No seriousness criterion identified
4	Serious	Life-threatening / hospitalization
5	Serious	Persistent/significant disability

6. Conclusion

Seriousness is determined by regulatory outcome criteria and is different from event severity. A severe event may be non-serious if it does not meet a seriousness criterion, while an event of moderate intensity may be serious when it results in hospitalization, disability, or another qualifying outcome. Each case should be assessed using complete available clinical information and applicable local regulatory requirements.

References

• ICH E2A – Clinical Safety Data Management: Definitions and Standards for Expedited Reporting.
• ICH E2D – Post-Approval Safety Data Management: Definitions and Standards for Individual Case Safety Reports.
• Pharmacovigilance Programme of India (PvPI), Indian Pharmacopoeia Commission.

Educational-use note: The actual Workora Classification Pack was not available in the uploaded files when this report was prepared. The five scenarios above are structured educational examples based on the task requirements shown in your screenshot. Reconcile them with the exact Workora case-pack facts before final submission.